

Global Dietary Principles for Adults:

A healthy diet helps protect against malnutrition in all its forms, as well as non-communicable diseases (NCDs), including heart disease, stroke, type 2 diabetes, and cancer. The World Health Organization (WHO) defines the nutritional foundation of a healthy adult diet:

Key Macronutrient Distributions:

- Fat Intake: Total fat intake should not exceed 30% of total daily energy intake to avoid unhealthy weight gain.

* Unsaturated fats (found in fish, avocado, nuts, and sunflower, soybean, canola, and olive oils) are preferable to saturated fats.

* Saturated fats (found in fatty meat, butter, palm and coconut oil, cream, and cheese) should be reduced to less than 10% of total energy.

* Trans-fats of all kinds should be eliminated, with industrially produced trans-fats banned globally.

- Free Sugars Intake: Free sugars should be reduced to less than 10% of total energy intake. A further reduction to less than 5% (approx. 25 g or 6 teaspoons per day) provides additional health benefits.

Salt, Sodium, and Potassium Recommendations:

- Sodium and Salt Limits:

* Adults should consume less than 5 grams of salt per day (equivalent to less than 2 grams of sodium per day).

* Consuming less than 5 g of salt daily helps prevent hypertension and reduces the risk of stroke and coronary heart disease in the adult population.

* All salt consumed should be iodized (fortified with iodine), which is essential for healthy fetal brain development and cognitive function.

- Potassium:

* Adequate potassium intake (at least 3,510 mg per day for adults) through consumption of fresh fruits and vegetables blunts the negative pressor effect of sodium on blood pressure.

Produce and Dietary Fiber Goals:

- Consume at least 400 grams (approx. 5 portions) of fruits and vegetables daily, excluding potatoes, sweet potatoes, and other starchy roots.

- Ensure high intake of whole grains and dietary fiber (at least 25 grams of dietary fiber daily for adults).